ANSWER KEY

QP CODE:25900576

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPOL200, MG3DSCPJM200 - INTRODUCTION TO POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. Individual Freedom.

2. Edmund Burke.

3. Democracy.

4. Right to Education.

5. Privacy.

6. An Ideal Society/State.

7. John Locke.

8. People/the Will of the People.

9. Social cooperation / shared political culture / common institutions.

10. Montesquieu.

PART B

11. Metaphysics concerns the fundamental nature of reality- focusing on existence, being, causality, and the relationship between mind and matter-seeks to understand what lies beyond the physical world and what constitutes ultimate reality

12. Rousseau's concept of the General Will represents the collective interest of the citizens aimed at the common good-transcends individual desires, guiding laws and governance to ensure freedom and equality within the social contract.

13. Authority is legitimate power accepted by those it governs, based on consent or law-power, by contrast, refers to the ability to influence or control others' behaviour, which may exist without legitimacy or moral justification.

14. The World Bank aids poverty alleviation by funding development projects, promoting education, healthcare, and infrastructure, and supporting economic reforms- provides technical expertise and low-interest loans to help developing nations build sustainable growth.

15. Political philosophy is limited by its abstract nature, cultural biases, and distance from practical politics-its idealistic assumptions may overlook power dynamics, economic realities, and historical conditions influencing real political processes.

16. Gandhi viewed civil disobedience as a moral duty to resist unjust laws peacefully- believed individuals must follow conscience and truth (satyagraha), asserting that moral obligation to justice overrides obedience to oppressive authority.

17. In pluralistic societies, justice faces challenges due to cultural diversity, conflicting values, and social inequalities-normative frameworks like Rawls's justice as fairness and multicultural models strive to balance liberty, equality, and fairness inclusively.

18. Marsilius of Padua justified political authority through the collective will of the people, rejecting papal supremacy-emphasized secular governance and popular sovereignty, though critics argue his model underestimates moral and spiritual authority.

19. Cultural cosmopolitanism promotes global citizenship, emphasizing openness, diversity, and shared human values amid migration-values hybrid identities and mutual respect but faces challenges from nationalism, inequality, and cultural assimilation pressures.

20. Principles of governance include accountability, ensuring leaders answer to the public-transparency, maintaining openness in decision-making- participation, involving citizens in governance; rule of law, ensuring justice; and responsiveness to public needs.

PART C

21. Political philosophy guides everyday politics by shaping moral and ethical standards for governance, citizenship, and justice-influences public debates, policymaking, and democratic participation by offering frameworks to evaluate authority, rights, and collective welfare in practical political contexts

22. Equality includes political, social, and economic dimensions ensuring fair opportunities and treatment-political equality secures participation rights, social equality promotes inclusion, and economic equality reduces disparities-these forms interact with liberty and justice by balancing individual freedom with fairness and collective well-being.

23. Theories on the nature of the state include idealist, realist, liberal, and Marxist views-Idealists see the state as a moral institution- realists emphasize power and security- liberals view it as a social contract ensuring rights-Marxists see it as a tool of class domination-feminist theory critiques patriarchy and demands gender equality in power structures-social contract theory sees the state as formed by individuals' consent for mutual protection-divine origin views it as God-given-evolutionary emphasizes gradual development-force theory bases it on coercion.

24. In globalization, sovereignty requires redefinition due to interdependence among states, global governance institutions, and transnational challenges-while absolute sovereignty weakens, cooperative sovereignty emerges, balancing national autonomy with international responsibility and collective action for global justice and security.